Dimitrios - Georgios **Kontopoulos**

Walter Benjamin Postdoctoral Fellow (he/him)

Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, University of California, Los Angeles, CA, United States of America

+1 424-402-7790 | dgkontopoulos@gmail.com | dgkontopoulos.io | @DGKontopoulos@ecoevo.social | Dimitrios - Georgios Kontopoulos

I am an integrative biologist. My research focuses on understanding **how diverse biological systems (from molecules to ecosystems) respond to environmental changes over various timescales**. I approach this goal using approaches from a wide range of fields, including ecoinformatics, phylogenetic comparative methods, comparative genomics, and behavioral experiments.

Research appointments and internships

- **Walter Benjamin Postdoctoral Fellow at Prof. Noa Pinter-Wollman's group**, University of California, Los Angeles, United States of America. — **June 2025 - Present**
- **Postdoctoral researcher at Prof. Michael Hiller's group**, LOEWE Centre for Translational Biodiversity Genomics & Senckenberg Research Institute, Frankfurt am Main, Germany. — **May 2021 - Dec. 2024**
- **Visiting researcher**, Imperial College London, Silwood Park, Ascot, United Kingdom. — **Dec. 2019 - Apr. 2021**
- **Research assistant at Prof. Samraat Pawar's group**, Imperial College London, Silwood Park, Ascot, United Kingdom. — **Oct. 2015 - Sep. 2016**; **Nov. 2014 - May 2015**
- **Postgraduate intern at Dr. Sofia Kossida's group**, Bioinformatics and Medical Informatics Lab of the Biomedical Research Foundation of the Academy of Athens, Athens, Greece. — **Nov. 2012 - Sep. 2013**
- **Summer intern at Prof. Marie-Paule Lefranc's group**, Laboratoire d'ImmunoGénétique Moléculaire of the Institut de Génétique Humaine, Montpellier, France. — **May - June 2013**
- **Summer intern at Prof. Zissis Mamuris' group**, Laboratory of Genetics, Comparative and Evolutionary Biology of the Department of Biochemistry and Biotechnology of the University of Thessaly, Larissa, Greece. — **July 2011**
- **Intern at Dr. George Skavdis' group**, Laboratory of Molecular Regulation of the Department of Molecular Biology and Genetics of the Democritus University of Thrace, Alexandroupolis, Greece. — **Mar. - May 2010**

Education

- **Imperial College London**, Silwood Park, Ascot, United Kingdom — **Oct. 2015 - Dec. 2019**
  PhD: "Limits to thermal adaptation in ectotherms"
- **Imperial College London**, Silwood Park, Ascot, United Kingdom — **Sep. 2013 - Sep. 2014**
  MRes Biodiversity Informatics and Genomics, graduated with Distinction.
  Thesis: "Phylogenetic constraints and environmental drivers of thermal adaptation among the phytoplankton"
- **Democritus University of Thrace**, Alexandroupolis, Greece — **Sep. 2008 - Oct. 2012**
  BSc Molecular Biology and Genetics, graduated with 7.46/10 ("Very Well").
  Thesis: "Pinda: a gene duplication detection program"

Publications

Peer-reviewed papers († equal contribution; ✉ corresponding author)

21 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**✉, Ahmed, A.-W., Bein, B., Levesque, D.L., & Hiller, M.✉ (2026) Lack of evidence for gene-level convergence linked to evolutionary shifts in torpor among placental mammals. *Genome Biology and Evolution*. *In press*. Preprint available from bioRxiv: doi:10.1101/2025.11.18.689136.

20 Morales, A.E., Liang, Y., Thomas, W.R., Leushkin E.V., Castellanos, F.X., Larkin, D.M., Brown, T., Fromm, B., Hand, S.J., Huang, Z., Hughes, G.M., Jones, M.F., Lim, B.K., Mai, M., Myers, E.W., Pippel, M., Puechmaille, S.J., Simmons, N.B., Abueg, L.A.L., Ahituv, N., AlAbdulsalam, Z.A., Alvarez van Tussenbroek, I., Aparicio, D.V., Arcila Hernández, L.M., Ben Hamadou, A., Benda, P., Blaxter, M., Borisenko, A.V., Brocca, J., Cabezón, N., Carbone, L., Carvajal, J.I., Chan, W.O.Y., Davis, P., Dechmann, D.K.N., Denzinger, A., Eger, J.L., Eiseb, S.J., Enard, D., Engstrom, M.D., Foley, N.M., Formenti, G., Fuller, J., Galván, I., Gamage, A.M., Gemmell, N.J., Gillum, J.E., Gonzales-Irribarren, A., Gonzalez, M.A., Goodman, S.M., Gray, J., Greve, C., Guernsey M.W., Gutiérrez, E.G., Guttman, Y., Hackenberg, M., Hilario, E., Hilgers, L., Horsley, T.W., Ingala de Waal, M.R., Jafferally, D.M., Jarvis, E.D., Joemratie, S.A., Knörnschild, M., Kohles, J.E., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Koo, B., Lauterbur, M.E., Letko, M., Lewin, H., Liu, S., Lizamore, D.K., Lloyd, B.D., Loureiro, L., MacSwiney G., M.C., Malovichko, Y.V., McCaffrey, K., Melville, D.W., Meyer, M., Mgoola, W.O., Muffato, M., Munster, V.J., Murphy, W.J., Nagy, M., Nesi, N., Nevonen, K.A., Nicolaou, H., Nkrumah, E.E., Norman, Z., O'Toole, B.P., Olson, S.H., Ondzie, A., Opoku, B.A., Ortega, J., Pearman, W.S., Perez-Llanos, F.J., Phelps, K.L., Pieri, M., Power, S., Prylutskyi, M., Pulido-Santacruz, P., Qi, G., Rodríguez-Herrera, B., Rojas, D., Roopsind, I., Rossiter, S.J., Scharff, C., Schnell, T., Seifert, S.N., Simal, F., Soisook, P., Sommer, S., Spalton, A., Stone, E.L., Sudmant, P.H., Talbot, S., Timm, R.M., Uelze, L., Upham, N.S., Uvizl, M., Vallo, P., Vazquez, J.M., Wang, L.-F., Watson, L.C., Whitby, D., Winkler, S., Winter, Y., Yohe, L.R., Zavodna, M., Zhang, N., Zhao, H., Ray, D.A. ✉, Vernes, S.C. ✉, Dávalos, L.M. ✉, Hiller, M. ✉, & Teeling, E.C. ✉ Reference genomes and fossils rewrite bat family-level phylogeny and global biogeography. *Nature*. *In press*.

19 Yi, X. ✉, **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, & Hiller, M. ✉ (2025) Comprehensive phylogenetic trait estimations support ancestral omnivory in the ecologically diverse bat family Phyllostomidae. *Evolution*. 79(11):2406-2420.

18 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, Patmanidis, I., Barraclough, T.G., & Pawar, S. (2025) Changes in flexibility but not in compactness underlie the thermal adaptation of prokaryotic adenylate kinases. *Evolution Letters*. 9(5):598-609.

17 Morales, A.E.†, Dong, Y.†, Brown, T., Baid, K., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Gonzalez, V., Huang, Z., Ahmed, A.-W., Bhuinya, A., Hilgers, L., Winkler, S., Hughes, G., Li, X., Lu, P., Yang, Y., Kirilenko, B.M., Devanna, P., Lama, T.M., Nissan, Y., Pippel, M., Dávalos, L.M., Vernes, S.C., Puechmaille, S.J., Rossiter, S.J., Yovel, Y., Prescott, J.B., Kurth, A., Ray, D.A., Lim, B.K., Myers, E., Teeling, E.C., Banerjee, A., Irving, A.T. ✉, & Hiller, M. ✉ (2025) Bat genomes illuminate adaptations to viral tolerance and disease resistance. *Nature*. 638:449-458.

16 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, Levesque, D.L., & Hiller, M. ✉ (2025) Numerous independent gains of daily torpor and hibernation across endotherms, linked with adaptation to diverse environments. *Functional Ecology*. 39(3):824-839.

15 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, Sentis, A., Daufresne, M., Glazman, N., Dell, A.I., & Pawar, S. (2024) No universal mathematical model for thermal performance curves across traits and taxonomic groups. *Nature Communications*. 15:8855. **[Co-second place winner of the 2025 Outstanding Paper Award from the Early Career Ecologists Section of the Ecological Society of America]**

14 Pawar, S. ✉, Huxley, P.J. ✉, Smallwood, T.R.C., Nesbit, M.L., Chan, A.H.H., Shocket, M.S., Johnson, L.R., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, & Cator, L.J. ✉ (2024) Variation in temperature of peak trait performance constrains adaptation of arthropod populations to climatic warming. *Nature Ecology & Evolution*. 8:500-510.

13 Kirilenko, B.M., Munegowda, C., Osipova, E., Jebb, D., Sharma, V., Blumer, M., Morales, A.E., Ahmed, A.-W., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Hilgers, L., Lindblad-Toh, K., Karlsson, E.K., Zoonomia Consortium, & Hiller, M. ✉ (2023) Integrating gene annotation with orthology inference at scale. *Science*. 380(6643):eabn3107.

12 Smith, T.P. ✉, Mombrikotb, S., Ransome, E., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Pawar, S., & Bell, T. (2022) Latent functional diversity may accelerate microbial community responses to temperature fluctuations. *eLife*. 11:e80867.

11 Kordas, R.L., Pawar, S., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Woodward, G., & O'Gorman, E.J. ✉ (2022) Metabolic plasticity can amplify ecosystem responses to global warming. *Nature Communications*. 13:2161.

10 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, Smith, T.P., Barraclough, T.G., & Pawar, S. (2020) Adaptive evolution shapes the present-day distribution of the thermal sensitivity of population growth rate. *PLOS Biology*. 18(10):e3000894.

9 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, van Sebille, E., Lange, M., Yvon-Durocher, G., Barraclough, T.G., & Pawar, S. (2020) Phytoplankton thermal responses adapt in the absence of hard thermodynamic constraints. *Evolution*. 74(4):775-790. **[Top cited article 2020-2021 in *Evolution*]**

8 García-Carreras, B. ✉, Sal, S., Padfield, D., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Bestion, E., Schaum, C.-E., Yvon-Durocher, G., & Pawar, S. ✉ (2018) Role of carbon allocation efficiency in the temperature dependence of autotroph growth rates. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. 115(31):E7361-E7368.

7 Kumbhar, R., Vidal-Eychenié, S., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Larroque, M., Larroque, C., Basbous, J., Kossida, S., Ribeyre, C., & Constantinou, A. ✉ (2018) Recruitment of ubiquitin-activating enzyme UBA1 to DNA by poly(ADP-ribose) promotes ATR signalling. *Life Science Alliance*. 1(3):e201800096.

6 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, García-Carreras, B., Sal, S., Smith, T.P., & Pawar, S. (2018) Use and misuse of temperature normalisation in meta-analyses of thermal responses of biological traits. *PeerJ*. 6:e4363.

5 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, Kontopoulou, T., Ho, H.-C., & García-Carreras, B. (2017) Towards a theoretically informed policy against a rakghoul plague outbreak. *The Medical Journal of Australia*. 207(11):490-494. **[Third place in the 2017 Christmas Competition of the *Medical Journal of Australia*]**

4 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉, Vlachakis, D. ✉, Tsiliki, G., & Kossida, S. (2016) Structuprint: a scalable and extensible tool for two-dimensional representation of protein surfaces. *BMC Structural Biology*. 16:4.

3 Kontopoulou, T.† ✉, **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**†, Vaidakis, E., & Mousoulis, G.P. (2015) Adult Kawasaki disease in a European patient: a case report and review of the literature. *Journal of Medical Case Reports*. 9(1):75.

2 Vlachakis, D., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, & Kossida, S. ✉ (2013) Space Constrained Homology Modelling: the paradigm of the RNA-dependent RNA polymerase of dengue (type II) virus. *Computational and Mathematical Methods in Medicine*. 2013:108910.

1 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** & Glykos, N.M. ✉ (2013) Pinda: a web service for detection and analysis of intraspecies gene duplication events. *Computer Methods and Programs in Biomedicine*. 111(3):711-714.

Commentaries

1 Pawar, S. ✉ & **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** (2025) Toward a general understanding of thermal performance curves in biology. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. 122(51):e2528528122.

Invited book chapters

1 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** ✉ Phylogenetic comparative approaches for the study of biological scaling. In: Synthesizing biological scaling: towards a universal theory. Santa Fe Institute Press. *In press*.

Manuscripts under review

1 Hilgers, L. ✉, Rovatsos, M., **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Brown, T., Hickler, T., Huntley, B., Pippel, M., Munegowda, C., Müller, T., Ahmed, A.-W., Laas, A., Praschag, P., Damas, J., Winkler, S., Lewin, H., Myers, E., Fritz, U., & Hiller, M. ✉ Side-necked turtle genomes reveal chromosomal dynamics, skeletal innovation and cancer resistance. Preprint available from bioRxiv: doi:10.64898/2026.03.05.709825.

Fellowships, scholarships, and awards

Total funds secured: >€430,000

9 Scholarship Award from the **Hellenic Bioscientific Association of the USA** for attending the 2026 Annual Meeting of the Ecological Society of America. $500 — **Apr. 2026**

8 Outstanding Paper Award (co-second place winner) from the **Early Career Ecologists Section of the Ecological Society of America** for peer-reviewed paper #15 above. — **Aug. 2025**

7 Walter Benjamin Postdoctoral Fellowship from the **German Research Foundation (DFG)**. €202,367 — **June 2025 - May 2028**

6 **EMBO** Postdoctoral Fellowship. €168,000 — **Mar. 2022 - Apr. 2024**

5 Top cited article award from ***Evolution*** for peer-reviewed paper #9 above. — **Mar. 2022**

4 Third place in the Christmas Competition of the ***Medical Journal of Australia*** for peer-reviewed paper #5 above. — **Dec. 2017**

3 Travel award from the **Department of Life Sciences, Imperial College London** for attending the 2017 Congress of the European Society for Evolutionary Biology in Groningen, the Netherlands. £500 — **May 2017**

2 Science and Solutions for a Changing Planet Doctoral Training Partnership scholarship from the **Natural Environment Research Council**. £57,300 — **Oct. 2015 - Apr. 2019**

1 Scholarship for 2013-2014 postgraduate education abroad (1st cycle) from the **Greek State Scholarships Foundation (IKY)**. €13,680 **Dec. 2013**

Presentations

Invited talks

4 **Evolution of ecophysiological responses to temperature changes.** Université Clermont Auvergne, France, 10th November 2023.

3 **Deep-time evolution of biological responses to temperature changes.** Ecology & Evolution Seminar Series, Imperial College London, Silwood Park Campus, United Kingdom, 10th October 2019.

2 **Deep-time evolution of physiological responses to temperature changes.** Stanford University, CA, United States of America, 13th September 2019.

1 **Trait correlations vs environmental drivers in the evolution of phytoplankton thermal responses.** National Taiwan University, Taiwan, 26th March 2018.

Contributed talks

10 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Tran, C., & Pinter-Wollman, N. (2026) Behavioral responses of Argentine ants to changes in climatic factors. *XX. International Congress of the International Union for the Study of Social Insects, Freiburg im Breisgau, Germany, 16-20th August*.

9 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Tran, C., Barreras, S., & Pinter-Wollman, N. (2026) Impacts of climatic factors on the physiology and social behavior of Argentine ants. *2026 Annual Meeting of the Ecological Society of America, Salt Lake City, UT, United States of America, 26-31st July*.

8 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Ahmed, A.-W., Bein, B., & Hiller, M. (2024) The impact of phylogenetic diversity on the strength of gene-trait associations. *18th Conference of the Hellenic Society for Computational Biology and Bioinformatics, Lamia, Greece, 17-19th October*.

7 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Levesque, D.L., & Hiller, M. (2023) Physiological, ecological, and genomic underpinnings of daily torpor and hibernation across mammals and birds. *2023 Annual Meeting of the Ecological Society of America, Portland, OR, United States of America, 6th-11th August*.

6 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, van Sebille, E., Lange, M., Yvon-Durocher, G., Barraclough, T.G., & Pawar, S. (2018) Non-random adaptive evolution of the thermal sensitivity of growth rate among phytoplankton. *Gordon Research Seminar on Unifying Ecology Across Scales, Biddeford, ME, United States of America, 21st-22nd July*.

5 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, van Sebille, E., Lange, M., Yvon-Durocher, G., & Pawar, S. (2018) Trait correlations vs environmental drivers in the evolution of phytoplankton thermal responses. *65th Annual Meeting of the Ecological Society of Japan, Sapporo, Japan, 14th-18th March*.

4 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Yvon-Durocher G., & Pawar, S. (2017) Niche convergence in the macroevolution of the thermal sensitivity of phytoplankton growth rate. *2017 Congress of the European Society for Evolutionary Biology, Groningen, the Netherlands, 20th-25th August*.

3 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Yvon-Durocher, G., & Pawar, S. (2016) Deep-time macroevolution of thermal sensitivity of growth rate among phytoplankton. *Annual Meeting of the British Ecological Society, Liverpool, United Kingdom, 11th-14th December*.

2 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Yvon-Durocher, G., Chen, B., Thomas, M. K. & Pawar S. (2014) Γενικά μοτίβα θερμικής προσαρμογής μεταξύ των ειδών του φυτοπλαγκτού [General patterns of thermal adaptation among phytoplankton]. *7th National Congress of the Hellenic Ecological Society, Mytilene, Greece, 9th-12th October*.

1 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.** & Glykos, N.M. (2012) Pinda: a web service for detection and analysis of intraspecies gene duplications. *7th Conference of the Hellenic Society for Computational Biology and Bioinformatics, Heraklion, Greece, 4th-6th October.*

Contributed posters

5 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Tran, C., Barreras, S, & Pinter-Wollman, N. (2026) Effects of temperature and relative humidity on the behavior of Argentine ants. *15th Annual Southern California Systems Biology Symposium, Los Angeles, CA, United States of America, 25th April*.

4 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Tran, C., Barreras, S, & Pinter-Wollman, N. (2026) Effects of temperature and relative humidity on the behavior of Argentine ants. *Southern California Animal Behavior Meeting, Claremont, CA, United States of America, 18th April*.

3 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Patmanidis, I., Barraclough, T.G., & Pawar, S. (2018) Nonsynonymous mutations are more detrimental at high temperatures; a prokaryote-wide study of adenylate kinases. *Gordon Research Conference on Unifying Ecology Across Scales, Biddeford, ME, United States of America, 22nd-27th July*.

2 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Yvon-Durocher, G., & Pawar, S. (2016) Deep-time macroevolution of thermal sensitivity of growth rate among phytoplankton. *Gordon Research Conference on Unifying Ecology Across Scales, Biddeford, ME, United States of America, 24th-29th July*.

1 **Kontopoulos, D.-G.**, Yvon-Durocher, G., Allen, A.P., Chen, B., Thomas, M.K., & Pawar, S. (2014) Phylogenetic constraints and environmental drivers of thermal adaptation among the phytoplankton. *Annual London Evolutionary Research Network Conference, London, United Kingdom, 5th November*.

Invited round table discussions

1 **Αποκρυπτογραφώντας τα σκαλιά της έρευνας [Deciphering the steps of research].** Summer School of the 4th Panhellenic Student Conference of Bioscientists, held online, 21st July 2026.

Research skills

Global change biology

- quantifying the shape of thermal performance curves for physiological, ecological, or other biological traits through diverse (80+) nonlinear mathematical models.
- identifying trait-trait and trait-environment associations through phylogenetic generalised linear mixed models with numerous (up to 22 so far) covarying response variables.
- Argentine ant sampling, conducting behavioral experiments at multiple temperatures and humidity levels, and analysing video recordings using Artificial Intelligence software.

Statistics & data science

- Bayesian statistics.
- phylogenetic comparative methods.
- likelihood-based model selection.
- dimensionality reduction and clustering.
- machine learning.

Bioinformatics

- genome alignment and annotation.
- Gene Ontology term enrichment.
- genome-wide screening for signatures of selection, gene losses, or evolutionary rate shifts, associated with a trait of interest.
- analysis of sequence or physicochemical conservation.
- protein structure modelling and comparison.
- molecular dynamics simulations.

Phylogenetics

- likelihood-based reconstruction of gene and species trees.
- timetree inference.

Ecological modelling

- modelling predator-prey population dynamics using ordinary differential equations.
- agent-based modelling with NetLogo.

Scientific programming

- extensive experience in Perl and R.
- good experience in Python and SQL.
- basic experience in Common Lisp, C, and Shell.
- version control using Git.
- some experience in web development.

Teaching

Certification

- **Associate Teaching Certificate**, Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL) **2026**

Course syllabi designed

- **Introduction to Thermal Biology** (semester-long) **2025**

Experience as a course demonstrator

- **Further Topics in Statistics** **2015-18**
  MSc/MRes "Ecology, Evolution and Conservation", Imperial College London
- **Intro to UNIX and Linux** **2017**
  MSc/MRes "Computational Methods in Ecology and Evolution" and "Quantitative and Modelling Skills in Ecology and Evolution" Centre for Doctoral Training, Imperial College London
- **Statistics** **2014-15**
  BSc "Biological Sciences", year 1, Imperial College London
- **Biological Computing in Python II** **2014**
  MSc/MRes "Computational Methods in Ecology and Evolution", Imperial College London
- **Computational Biostatistics** **2014**
  BSc "Biological Sciences", year 2, Imperial College London

Experience as a course tutor

- **MSc/MRes "Computational Methods in Ecology and Evolution"**, Imperial College London **2014-15**

Experience as a workshop presenter

- **"How to generate topological constraints using the Open Tree of Life"** **30th Mar. 2017**
  Silwood Computer Skillz Workshop, Imperial College London

Mentoring

High school student interns

- **Nathan Kuo** - Los Angeles. **2026**
  Duties: determining ant counts and body lengths from images using ImageJ.

Undergraduate interns

- **Sofia Barreras** - BS "Atmospheric and Oceanic Sciences", University of California, Los Angeles. **2026**
  Duties: determining ant counts and body lengths from images using ImageJ.
- **Catherine Tran** - BS "Ecology, Evolution, and Behavior", University of California, Los Angeles. **2025-26**
  Duties: determining ant counts from images using ImageJ.

Master's students

- **Georgios Kalogiannis** - MRes "Computational Methods in Ecology and Evolution", Imperial College London. **2024**
  Thesis: "Gene loss is an important signature of insect size evolution"
  Primary supervisor: Samraat Pawar
- **Aditi Madkaikar** - MRes "Computational Methods in Ecology and Evolution", Imperial College London. **2023**
  Thesis: "Predicting the thermal niche of a ubiquitous bacterium using whole genome sequence"
  Primary supervisor: Samraat Pawar
  Other supervisors: Arianna Basile

- **Kate Griffin** - MSc "Computational Methods in Ecology and Evolution", Imperial College London. **2022**
  Thesis: "Can't stand the heat? An analysis of the thermal sensitivity of arthropods, how it has evolved & factors influencing it"
  Primary supervisor: Samraat Pawar
  Other supervisors: Paul Huxley, Lauren Cator

Selected media coverage

Mentions in popular press

- Feature in the **"Feedback" column of the New Scientist** for peer-reviewed paper #16 above. **5th Feb. 2025**

Institutional press releases and highlights

- Press release from the **Senckenberg Society for Nature Research** for peer-reviewed paper #16 above. **27th Jan. 2025**
  Distributed by the idw ("Science Information Service") and the VBIO ("German Life Sciences Association").
- Highlight from **Imperial College London** for peer-reviewed paper #10 above. **13th Nov. 2020**

Synergistic activities

- Invited member of the working group "**Climate Change, Biodiversity, and Environmental Justice: A Synthesis of Ecological and Socioeconomic Risks**", University of Notre Dame and University of Michigan. PIs: Jason Rohr and Thiago Gonçalves-Souza. **2026 - Present**

Outreach / public engagement

- Exhibitor at the **Great Exhibition Road Festival**, London, UK **7th-8th May 2016**
- Co-organiser of the **"Drawing Climate Change" activity at the Science Museum Lates**, London, UK **30th Mar. 2016**

Service

- Manuscript reviewer for 16 Journals / peer review platforms: ***Communications Biology***, ***Communications Earth & Environment***, ***Ecology Letters***, ***eLife***, ***Frontiers in Microbiology***, ***Functional Ecology***, ***Global Ecology and Biogeography***, ***Journal of Plankton Research***, ***Journal of Thermal Biology***, ***Life Science Alliance***, ***Limnology and Oceanography***, ***Physiological and Biochemical Zoology***, ***Proceedings of the Royal Society B: Biological Sciences***, ***Review Commons***, ***Scientific Reports***, and ***Systematic Biology***.
- Reviewer for the 2026 **Graduate Research Excellence Grants** of the Society for the Study of Evolution.
- Poster judge for the 2026 **EEB Research Day** of the University of California, Los Angeles.

Scientific workshops and courses attended

Pedagogy, mentoring, and leadership

6 **Culturally Responsive Pedagogy in Ecology: Teaching to engage diverse ecologists in an era of uncertainty**, 2026 Annual Meeting of the Ecological Society of America, Salt Lake City, UT, United States of America. **26th July 2026**

5 **Decentering Grades: Getting Started with Ungrading for Future Faculty**, CIRTL Network, held online. **2nd Mar. 2026**

4 **Maximizing Learning Outcomes from Instructional Demonstration: Balancing Instructor- and Student-Led Experiential Learning**, CIRTL Network, held online. **17th Feb. 2026**

3 **CIRTL@UCLA Introduction to Evidence-Based Undergraduate Teaching course**, University of California, Los Angeles, CA, United States of America. **Sep. 2025 - Dec. 2025**

2 **CIMER/NRMN Postdoc Research Mentoring Workshop**, University of California, Los Angeles, CA, United States of America. **28th Aug. 2025**

1 **EMBO Laboratory Leadership course**, EMBO Solutions, Heidelberg, Germany. **5th-7th July 2023**

Others

3 **An Introduction to Mechanistic Niche Modelling with NicheMapR and TrenchR**, 2023 Annual Meeting of the Ecological Society of America, Portland, OR, United States of America. **6th Aug. 2023**

2 **"Introduction to Agent-Based Modelling" Massive Open Online Course**, Santa Fe Institute, held online. **June 2022 - Aug. 2022**

1 **Evolutionary Quantitative Genetics workshop**, Friday Harbor Laboratories, University of Washington, held online. **11th-15th July 2022**

Language skills

Native proficiency in **Greek**, full proficiency in **English**, sufficient proficiency in **French**, basic proficiency in **German**.

References

Prof. Samraat Pawar
Title: Professor of Theoretical Ecology
Affiliation: Department of Life Sciences, Imperial College London, Silwood Park
Email address: s.pawar@imperial.ac.uk

Prof. Michael Hiller
Title: Professor of Comparative Genomics
Affiliation: Senckenberg Research Institute, Frankfurt and Goethe University
Email address: michael.hiller@senckenberg.de

Prof. Noa Pinter-Wollman
Title: Professor
Affiliation: Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, University of California, Los Angeles
Email address: nmpinter@ucla.edu

Prof. Timothy G. Barraclough
Title: Professor of Evolutionary Biology
Affiliation: Department of Biology, University of Oxford
Email address: tim.barraclough@biology.ox.ac.uk

Additional information

Member of Scientific Societies: Society for the Study of Evolution, Ecological Society of America, North American Section of the International Union for the Study of Social Insects, Panhellenic Association of Bioscientists, Hellenic Bioscientific Association of the USA.

Last updated: 2026–08–28